Outlook

Seller Settlement with Bulk and Complaint Window BRD

From Zinto <zintoindia@gmail.com>
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To Harshvardhan Panchal <harshvardhanpanc145@gmail.com>

3 attachments (383 KB)
zinto-complaint-window-ui.html; zinto-seller-settlement-ui.html; Seller Settlement and Complaint flow chart.pdf;

Hi Harshvardhan,
as discussed Saler settlement and Complaint Windows details attached for reference.

BRD – Seller Settlement, Bulk Settlement and Complaint Window (Zinto)

Draft v1.0 · 10-Oct-2026 · Source: product discussions, UI previews and flow charts

1. Purpose and Summary

Zinto is a hyper-local marketplace. The customer pays the final bill to Zinto through Razorpay. After delivery, Zinto pays the seller. This document defines three connected features so a developer can build them without guessing:

- **Complaint Window:** the customer can raise feedback or a complaint within 24 hours of delivery. A complaint must be closed within 7 days. Admin decides who is responsible and who pays.
- **Seller Settlement:** for each delivered order, Finance or Admin checks that everything is clear, reviews the deductions, and pays the seller manually or through Razorpay.
- **Bulk Settlement:** Finance or Admin settles many ready orders of one seller in one action, with one reference number.

The goal is that a seller is paid the right amount, on time, with a clear invoice, and that every step is traceable.

2. Scope, Roles and References

In scope: complaint window (customer, seller, Admin), settlement list, single settlement window, bulk settlement, seller view with settlement invoice, notifications, audit log.

Out of scope for now: automatic complaint decisions, logistics partner recovery beyond raising a ticket, and customer-to-seller chat.

Role	What they do
Customer	Raises feedback or complaint within 24 hours, tracks the ticket.
Seller	Reviews complaints against their products, approves or rejects, sees settled amounts and settlement invoices.
Admin	Calls the customer, decides the culprit, routes and closes complaints, settles sellers.
Finance	Reviews and pays settlements, single or bulk.
Platform Owner	Sees everything, including commission and profit.

3. Business Rules at a Glance

Rule	Value
Complaint window	24 hours from delivery. After that no feedback or complaint can be raised.
Resolution time	A raised complaint must be closed within 7 days.
Ready to settle	All four checks are green: delivered, Razorpay payment received, no open complaint (window closed, complaint none or closed), no pending penalty or seller issue.
Settled amount	Quoted item price − complaint deduction − packing − extra charge − quality issue − price mismatch − miscellaneous.
Example order	Customer pays ₹235 = item ₹100 + GST 5% ₹5 + commission 30% ₹30 + delivery ₹100. Zinto pays the rider ₹99. The seller is owed the quoted ₹100, less any deductions.

Gateway fee	Razorpay deducts about 2.35% when paying Zinto after 2–3 days (about ₹5.52 on ₹235). To be confirmed.
Who pays a complaint	Seller: deducted at settlement. Platform: from commission. Logistics: platform pays now and raises a recovery ticket.
Closing a complaint	Only Admin, with at least one culprit named and a final summary.
Bulk settlement	One seller only. Ready orders only. One reference number for all orders and invoices.
Visibility	Commission, platform fee, gateway fee and profit are visible only to Admin and Finance.

4. Complaint Window

ID	Requirement	Priority
CMP-01	A complaint window opens for each delivered order for 24 hours. The customer sees a countdown.	Must
CMP-02	After 24 hours the window is disabled in the app and in the API.	Must
CMP-03	A raised complaint must be closed within 7 days. The ticket shows days left.	Must
CMP-04	Day 5 alert to Admin and Platform Owner. After day 7 the ticket is flagged Overdue. (assumed)	Should
CMP-05	The customer selects one, several or all products of the order.	Must
CMP-06	For each product the customer picks a reason: item spoiled, delayed, missing, wrong item, damaged or leaked packaging, short quantity, quality not as shown, overcharged, rider behaviour, order not delivered, or other with free text.	Must

CMP-07	Up to 3–4 photos per product.	Must
CMP-08	The customer submits as Feedback or as Complaint and receives a ticket number.	Must
CMP-09	Feedback goes to the seller for that order and product and Admin is notified. Admin acknowledges and the loop closes. Feedback has no refund and no settlement hold.	Must
CMP-10	A complaint goes to the Admin Complaint window with status New. The 7-day timer starts and the order's settlement is held.	Must
CMP-11	Admin calls the customer from the app and writes a call log (who, time, duration, facts, photos checked, outcome, next step). A call log is required before routing or closing.	Must
CMP-12	Admin decides the culprit: seller, rider or logistics, platform, or customer (false complaint, assumed) and routes the ticket.	Must
CMP-13	The seller sees the product and photos, then approves with an amount or rejects with a reason. A rejection returns the ticket to Admin.	Must
CMP-14	Admin can reassign any number of times, to anyone. Each reassignment is recorded.	Must
CMP-15	Seller at fault: the amount is deducted in the seller settlement with the complaint number. Platform at fault: paid from commission and order profit reduces. Logistics at fault: platform pays, the profit summary shows 'delivery issue paid' and a recovery ticket is raised.	Must
CMP-16	The customer is refunded and receives a message with the amount and transaction number.	Must
CMP-17	Only Admin can close a complaint, with at least one named culprit and a final summary.	Must
CMP-18	Customer, seller and Admin can all see the complaint status. The customer sees simple statuses, not the internal back and forth. (assumed)	Must

CMP-19	A message goes to the customer at every status change, and every step is written to a read-only audit log (who, what, when, old and new status, notes, device).	Must

Statuses: New → Under review → Call done → Assigned → Seller approved or Seller rejected → Refunded → Closed. Overdue is a flag, not a status.

5. Seller Settlement (single order)

5.1 Settlement list

ID	Requirement	Priority
SET-01	Columns in this order: checkbox, Date, Order ID, Customer Name, Seller Name, Settlement amount, Reviewed / Not reviewed, Settle Now / Settled, check dots, View. Customer Name is its own column. Order ID shows the ID only.	Must
SET-02	Column headers are links and each column sorts ascending and descending.	Must
SET-03	The list is paginated.	Must
SET-04	Wildcard search (* and ?) matches order ID, item name, customer name, seller name and phone number of any order.	Must
SET-05	Four dots before View: delivered, Razorpay paid, no open complaint, no penalty. Green = clear, amber = waiting (for example complaint window still open), red = needs action. Each dot has a tooltip.	Must
SET-06	Settle Now is green only when all four dots are green. Otherwise it is grey and disabled.	Must
SET-07	If an order has a complaint, its complaint number appears as a link that opens that complaint directly.	Must
SET-08	The Order ID link opens a cart page with every item, quantity, unit price, line total and item total.	Must
SET-09	Wherever the item price is shown to Admin or Finance, an Order invoice link opens the customer's order invoice.	Must

5.2 Settlement window

ID	Requirement	Priority
SET-10	The header shows order ID, customer name, seller, date and a View items link.	Must
SET-11	An 'Order money' box (Admin and Finance only) shows what the customer paid, item price, GST, commission, delivery charge, rider cost and gateway fee.	Should
SET-12	Check 1: order delivered, with a link to order details.	Must
SET-13	Check 2: Razorpay payment received (pulled from the Razorpay API).	Must
SET-14	Check 3: complaint status. It always shows a Complaint no. line: the number as a link, or 'None yet'. If a complaint exists, the deduction amount is shown.	Must
SET-15	Check 4: seller issues with a price box for each of packing, extra charge, quality issue, price mismatch and miscellaneous.	Must
SET-16	The top line shows what the seller deserves (the quoted price). Deductions are listed below it. The last line is the settled amount, recalculated live as boxes change.	Must
SET-17	The reviewer marks the order as reviewed before payment. Payment is blocked until the order is reviewed.	Must

5.3 Payment

ID	Requirement	Priority
SET-18	Two payment modes: Automatic (Razorpay payout) and Manual.	Must
SET-19	Manual: show the seller's UPI ID and QR, then require the transaction number.	Must
SET-20	Automatic: call the Razorpay payout API and store the payout ID and UTR. Final status comes from the webhook.	Must
SET-21	A seller can never be marked paid without a transaction number or payout ID.	Must

SET-22	After success the order shows Settled, a settlement invoice is created, ledger entries are posted, and the amounts are locked.	Must
SET-23	A failed payout shows Failed with a Retry action. Retries must not pay twice.	Must

6. Bulk Settlement

ID	Requirement	Priority
BLK-01	A Bulk Settlement button at the top right of the list. If rows of one seller are ticked, they carry over. Rows of different sellers are not allowed.	Must
BLK-02	The Bulk page starts with a seller selector. After choosing, all unsettled orders of that seller appear with the same columns and dots as the list.	Must
BLK-03	Select All selects only ready orders. Orders that are not ready cannot be ticked.	Must
BLK-04	A summary row shows: number of orders selected, seller name, total amount to settle, Review, Settle Now.	Must
BLK-05	Review shows a table (or PDF) with every selected order: order ID, customer, seller, delivered, Razorpay status, no complaint, no penalty and the amount, with a total.	Must
BLK-06	Settle Now follows the same payment process as a single settlement (review confirmed, manual or automatic, transaction number).	Must
BLK-07	One reference number (for example BS-2610-001) is created and saved on every order, every settlement invoice and the seller notification. Invoices say 'Bulk settlement'.	Must
BLK-08	If some payouts fail, the successful orders stay Settled and the failed ones show Failed. The reference number stays the same. (assumed)	Should

7. Seller View, Invoices and Notifications

ID	Requirement	Priority
SLV-01	The seller's order table shows Order ID, Customer Name, Date, Amount (quoted), Settled amount, Status and Invoice (attachment) as separate columns.	Must
SLV-02	The settled amount is red while pending and green once credited.	Must
SLV-03	The Invoice column opens the seller's settlement invoice: quoted amount, each deduction, settled amount and transaction number, plus the bulk reference if it was a bulk settlement.	Must
SLV-04	The seller never sees the customer's order invoice.	Must
SLV-05	The seller's order link shows items, quantities and prices only. It hides the customer phone, what the customer paid, platform fee and commission.	Must
SLV-06	On every settlement the seller gets a notification with Order ID, Customer Name, Amount and Settled amount in separate columns, and the invoice attached.	Must
SLV-07	Sellers can see complaints against their products and the deduction linked to a complaint number.	Must

8. Security, Roles and Audit

ID	Requirement	Priority
SEC-01	Commission, platform fee, gateway fee and profit are shown only to Admin and Finance (and any role the Platform Owner allows). Operators and sellers never see them.	Must
SEC-02	Customer phone and address are masked. Wildcard search can match a phone number, but results show only a masked number.	Must
SEC-03	Audit log is read-only for complaints and settlements. Entries are never edited or deleted. Corrections are new entries.	Must

SEC-04	Each audit entry stores who, role, what, when, old value, new value, reason and device or IP.	Must
SEC-05	Reviewer and payer are both recorded. Whether they must be different people is an open question.	Should

9. Integrations and Data

- **Razorpay:** payment status for check 2, payout API and a webhook for payout success or failure.
- **Ledger and accounting:** every settlement, complaint deduction and platform-paid complaint posts to the ledger automatically, tagged with order, seller and complaint number.
- **Notifications:** in-app, plus SMS or WhatsApp if enabled.
- **Configuration:** the 24-hour window, 7-day limit, GST rate, commission rate and delivery charge are settings, not fixed in code.

10. Dos and Don'ts for Developers

Do

Complaint window

- Do calculate the 24-hour window from the delivery time saved on the server, never from the phone's clock.
- Do block new complaints after 24 hours in both the screen and the API.
- Do hold the order's settlement the moment a complaint (not feedback) is created, and release it only when Admin closes it.
- Do write the audit entry in the same database transaction as the status change.
- Do send the customer a message at every status change.
- Do require a call log before Admin routes or closes, and a culprit plus summary before closing.
- Do keep full history when Admin reassigns, however many times.
- Do validate photos (type, size, maximum 4 per product).
- Do show the 7-day countdown and the Overdue flag.

Settlement and money

- Do store money as whole paise (integers) and round only for display.
- Do save the quoted price, GST and commission on the order when it is placed, and use those saved values later.
- Do recalculate the settled amount on the server when paying. Never trust an amount sent from the browser.
- Do decide 'ready to settle' on the server, and enable Settle Now only from that decision.
- Do make payment idempotent, with a unique key per settlement or bulk settlement, so a retry or double click cannot pay twice.
- Do require review before pay, and a transaction number (manual) or payout ID (automatic) before marking Settled.
- Do lock amounts after Settled.

- Do post ledger entries automatically after a successful payment.
- Do wait for the Razorpay webhook before marking an automatic payout Settled and notifying the seller.

Bulk

- Do allow bulk for one seller at a time and only for ready orders.
- Do create one reference number and save it on every order, invoice and notification in the batch.
- Do handle partial failure per order and show it clearly.

Search, lists and screens

- Do run search, sort and pagination on the server. Escape the wildcard text safely, converting * and ? only.
- Do keep Customer Name as its own column and show the Order ID alone.
- Do show a complaint number link wherever an order has a complaint, and an Order invoice link next to item price for Admin and Finance.
- Do keep green, amber and red dots consistent, with tooltips.

Seller view

- Do show Amount (quoted) and Settled amount as two columns, red then green, with the settlement invoice as the attachment.

Don't

Complaint window

- Don't allow any complaint after the 24-hour window in this version.
- Don't let sellers, operators or customers close a complaint. Only Admin can.
- Don't close a complaint without a named culprit and a written summary.
- Don't show the customer the internal back and forth between Admin and seller (assumed).
- Don't hold or deduct anything for plain feedback.

Settlement and money

- Don't use floating-point numbers for money.
- Don't enable Settle Now while any dot is amber or red.
- Don't pay an order whose settlement is held by an open complaint.
- Don't mark a seller paid without a transaction number or payout ID.
- Don't allow edits to deductions or amounts after the order is Settled.
- Don't hard-code 24 hours, 7 days, 5% GST, 30% commission or the delivery charge.
- Don't let a failed or repeated payout request pay the seller twice.
- Don't send a 'credited' notification before the payment is confirmed.

Bulk

- Don't mix sellers in one bulk settlement.
- Don't include orders that are not ready, even if the user ticks them by tampering with the request.
- Don't create different reference numbers for orders in the same bulk settlement.

Security and data

- Don't show commission, platform fee, gateway fee or profit to sellers or operators.
- Don't show the customer's order invoice in the Seller View.
- Don't show the customer's full phone or address to sellers or in search results.
- Don't edit or delete audit log entries or complaint events.
- Don't trust the browser to decide permissions. Check the role on every API call.

11. Test Scenarios

#	Scenario	Expected result
1	Order delivered 2 hours ago, no complaint	Complaint dot amber, Settle Now grey.
2	24 hours pass, all checks green	All dots green, Settle Now green.
3	Customer raises a complaint at hour 20	Ticket created, settlement held, customer message sent.
4	Customer tries to raise a complaint at hour 25	Blocked in the app and in the API.
5	Seller approves ₹50 on a ₹100 item	Settled amount ₹50, deduction linked to the complaint number.
6	Seller rejects	Ticket returns to Admin, who can reassign.
7	Admin marks platform as culprit, ₹50	Refund sent, paid from commission, order profit reduces by ₹50.
8	Close without a summary	Blocked.
9	Manual payment without a transaction number	Blocked.
10	Click Pay twice quickly	One payout only.

11	Bulk: 3 ready orders of one seller, ₹100 + ₹180 + ₹95	Total ₹375, one reference number on all three orders and invoices.
12	Bulk with orders of two sellers	Blocked with a message.
13	Wildcard search for Rasa*	Orders containing items starting with Rasa appear.
14	Seller opens an order	Sees items and prices only. No phone, commission or customer invoice.

12. Open Questions and Assumptions

- **Settlement hold:** assumed the whole order is held. Confirm whether only the complained amount should be held.
- **Refund timing:** confirm whether the customer is refunded first and Zinto recovers later, or only after the seller approves.
- **False complaints:** confirm that Customer can be a culprit with no refund.
- **Photos:** confirm whether photos are mandatory for every complaint or only some reasons.
- **Day 5 alert and Overdue flag:** assumed, please confirm.
- **Gateway fee:** the notes said the Razorpay deduction is about 2.35% (about ₹5.52 on ₹235) but also mentioned ₹200. Confirm the correct figure.
- **Payout fees:** confirm who bears any Razorpay payout fee when Zinto pays the seller.
- **Payout timing:** confirm the number of days between the end of the complaint window and the seller payout.
- **Maker and checker:** confirm whether the reviewer and the payer must be different people.
- **Bulk partial failure:** assumed per-order status with one reference. Confirm.
- **Commission visibility for accountants:** confirm whether the Accountant role may see commission, as raised in the Accountant dashboard BRD.